

THE BLANK SHEET OPERATOR

Companion Toolkit

*Eighteen printable tools for finding, testing,
structuring, funding, and deciding on ventures*

EMMANUEL C. IKEHI

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THE BLANK SHEET OPERATOR: COMPANION TOOLKIT

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These tools accompany the book *The Blank Sheet Operator: Structuring, Pricing, and Delivering High-Value Ventures in Volatile Markets*. Readers of the book may print and use them for their own ventures. They are provided for educational purposes and do not constitute financial, legal, tax, or investment advice. All figures in the examples are illustrative.

www.emmanuelikehi.com

The Tools

Every chapter ends with a tool. This toolkit prints a blank, ready-to-use version of all eighteen tools from the book. Print a page, or copy it onto your own paper.

Use each tool on a live opportunity, not a hypothetical one. Write the numbers in pencil, because they will change. Where a formula is shown, the calculation is the same one used in the worked examples in the chapters.

Ch.	Tool	Use it to
1	Blank Sheet Operator Canvas	Capture an opportunity on one page
2	Opportunity Scorecard	Score ten dimensions with evidence
3	Kill-Test Sheet	Set thresholds and decisions before testing
4	Feasibility Matrix	Find the weakest of five pillars
5	Unit Economics Model	Build base, downside, and upside cases
6	Capacity Economics Calculator	Find break-even utilisation
7	Validation Experiment Planner	Test the riskiest assumption cheaply
8	Proposal and Pricing Template	Price work in stages
9	Commercial Structure Builder	Compare deal structures
10	Revenue Share Calculator	Stress-test a multi-party split

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Ch.	Tool	Use it to
11	Lean Team and Dependency Audit	Decide what to own and what to rent
12	Pre-Sales Validation Toolkit	Track commitments, not conversations
13	Runway Reallocation Calculator	Extend runway and plan a pause
14	Capital Requirement Model	Tie funding to proof
15	Internal Venture Charter	Govern a venture inside an organisation
16	Technology-to-Economics Map	Link technology to a number
17	Build, Buy, Partner Decision Tool	Score the options with weights
18	Scale, Pivot, or Kill Dashboard	Make the final decision

Tool 1: Blank Sheet Operator Canvas (Chapter 1)

Fill this in before you commit any money. If you cannot complete a box, that box is your first piece of work.

Box	Your answer
The opportunity, in two sentences	
Who hurts, and how badly	
Who pays (the person with budget)	
What they do today, and what it costs	
The economic unit (one sale, one machine-day, one room-night)	
Ten things that must be true	
The most dangerous assumption	
The cheapest credible test	
The kill threshold (what would make us stop)	
Decision date	

Tool 2: Opportunity Scorecard (Chapter 2)

Score each dimension from 0 to 5 using evidence, not enthusiasm. For Competition, Capital, Complexity, and Regulation, a high score means the condition is favourable.

Dimension	Score (0 to 5)	Evidence	Confidence (H, M, L)	Next test
Pain				
Demand				
Payment				
Market				
Timing				
Competition				
Capital				
Complexity				
Regulation				
Advantage				
Total (out of 50)				

Bands (heuristic): 40 to 50 strong; 30 to 39 promising but flawed; 20 to 29 risky; below 20 walk away or reframe.

Why now?

Why us? _____

Lowest score and the test it demands:

Tool 3: Kill-Test Sheet (Chapter 3)

Complete the first four columns before the test begins.
Complete the rest afterwards. Do not edit the thresholds after you see the result.

Assumption	Threshold	Deadline	Pre-agreed response if missed	Actual result	Verdict (Stop, Rework, Pivot, Continue)	Next action and owner
Demand						
Price						
Acquisition cost						
Retention						
Contribution margin						
Capital						

Money spent so far: _____ **Money saved if we stop now rather than at the next planned stage:** _____

Neutral person who holds me to these thresholds:

Decision meeting date (within seven days of the result): _____

Tool 4: Feasibility Matrix (Chapter 4)

Score each pillar from 1 to 5 (1 is little or no credible evidence, 5 is strong and repeatable). The lowest score decides the next test.

Pillar	Score	Evidence	Weakest-link test	Owner	Deadline	Score after test
Commercial: will customers pay?						
Financial: can the economics work?						
Technical: can we build it?						
Legal: can we legally operate it?						
Operational: can we deliver it?						
Capital: can we fund the next proof?						

Lowest pillar: _____ **Minimum capital to buy the next evidence:** _____

Tool 5: Unit Economics Model (Chapter 5)

Work down the ladder for one unit, then stress it. Contribution (CM1) is revenue less delivery, transaction, and acquisition costs. CM2 also removes direct unit support costs.

Line (per unit)	Base	Downside	Upside
Price			
Realised revenue (after discounts and refunds)			
Direct delivery cost			
Transaction drag (fees, FX, fraud)			
Direct acquisition cost			
CM1 = revenue minus the three costs above			
Direct unit support (maintenance, storage)			
CM2 = CM1 minus unit support			
Monthly fixed costs			

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Line (per unit)	Base	Downside	Upside
Break-even units a month = fixed costs divided by CM2			
Utilisation (if a capacity business)			
Payback = investment divided by monthly contribution			
Working capital gap = monthly revenue times (days to collect minus days to pay) divided by 30			

Stress test: price down __%, direct cost up __%, acquisition cost up __%, utilisation down __ points, payment delayed __ days. **Where is the cliff?**

Tool 6: Capacity Economics Calculator (Chapter 6)

Step	Input or formula	Your figure
A. Available units per month		
B. Fixed capacity cost per month		
C. Average realised price per used unit		
D. Variable cost per used unit		
E. Contribution per used unit	C minus D	
F. Break-even units	B divided by E	
G. Break-even utilisation	F divided by A	
H. Current utilisation		
I. Utilisation if demand falls 25%	H times 0.75	
J. Revenue per available unit (RevPAU)	H times C	

Capacity allocation (heuristic starting point):

Tier	Share of capacity	Your allocation	Pricing approach
Base-load anchor	50 to 60%		

Tier	Share of capacity	Your allocation	Pricing approach
Standard commercial	25 to 35%		
Spot and dynamic yield	10 to 15%		

Is break-even utilisation comfortably below realistic demand? If not, what can change: fixed cost, price, variable cost, or the structure? _____

Tool 7: Validation Experiment Planner (Chapter 7)

Field	Your answer
The assumption being tested	
Why it is the most dangerous one	
Three possible tests, with cost and time for each	
The test chosen, and why it is the cheapest that requires real commitment	
What the customer must risk (money, time, access, reputation)	
Minimum viable business: customer, offer, price	
Minimum viable business: acquisition channel and payment mechanism	
Minimum viable business: fulfilment steps done by hand	
Direct cost of each manual step	
Success threshold	
Kill threshold	

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Field	Your answer
Automation trigger (repeated, expensive, stable)	
Evidence that would justify building the real machine	
Start date and end date	

Tool 8: Proposal and Pricing Template (Chapter 8)

Part 1: The Unknown-to-Certainty Map

Area	Known	Unknown	Discovery required?	Pricing method
Requirements				
Integrations				
Development				
Deployment				
Support				

Part 2: Phased pricing

Stage	Deliverables	Acceptance criteria (testable)	Price	Payment trigger
1. Discovery and architecture				
2. Core platform				
3. Custom logic and integrations				
4. Pilot, deployment, handover				
Total				

Part 3: Protections. Write one or two sentences for each.

- Included and excluded:
- Assumptions:
- Client dependencies:
- Change request process:
- What triggers a change in price or timing:
- Who holds what risk:

Tool 9: Commercial Structure Builder (Chapter 9)

Part 1: The Commercial Architecture Sheet

Item	Term
Price	
Payment schedule and cash timing	
Minimum commitment	
Scope included	
Scope excluded	
Capacity limit	
Variable and emergency charges	
Change request mechanism	
Performance obligations	
Customer dependencies	
Our dependencies	
Liability boundary	
Renewal	
Termination and exit	
Peak cash we must fund before being paid	

Part 2: Compare structures

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Structure	Our income (low)	Our income (base)	Our income (high)	Who carries the risk	Peak cash exposure
A:					
B:					
C:					

Tool 10: Revenue Share Calculator (Chapter 10)

Part 1: The split under different performance.

Payout to a party equals gross revenue times its percentage. Net for a party that carries direct costs equals its payout minus those costs.

Utilisation or performance	Gross revenue	Party A (___%)	Party B (___%)	Party C (___%)	Direct costs carried by	Net after costs
Upside						
Base						
Downside						
Severe downside						

Who goes under first? What fix: cost floor, sliding share, performance bonus, or step-in right?

Part 2: Player Alignment Matrix

Player	Contributes	Controls	Risks	Receives	Consequence of failure

Part 3: Decision rights

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Decision	Decides	Consulted	Informed
Accept a major customer			
Approve discounts			
Spend reserve funds			
Change the split			
Terminate a party			

Tool 11: Lean Team and Dependency Audit (Chapter 11)

Part 1: Capabilities for the next stage only

Capability	Internal, contract, or deferred ?	Who	Monthly cost	IP owned by us?	Dependency risk

Part 2: Operator Dependency Audit. List the last thirty recurring tasks you handled.

Task	Frequency	Hours a week	Needs my judgement?	Keep, delegate, automate, or eliminate	Escalation trigger

Contractor checklist:

- ☐ Written specification with acceptance criteria

- ☐ IP assignment signed before work starts
- ☐ Code in a repository we own
- ☐ Accounts and credentials registered in the company's name
- ☐ Documentation tied to the final payment
- ☐ Handover plan if the contractor leaves

Tool 12: Pre-Sales Validation Toolkit (Chapter 12)

Part 1: The tracker

Prospect	Need	Buyer	Proposal	LOI	Pilot	Bought	Repeat

Part 2: Customer profile (one per prospect)

Field	Answer
Problem and its cost	
What they do today	
User, economic buyer, technical gatekeeper, procurement, decision-maker	
Budget	
Outcome required	
Price offered	
Commitment requested	
Main objection	
Next step and date	

Part 3: Interview prompts

- Tell me about the last time this problem happened. What did you do?
- What are you paying today, in money and time?
- What have you tried, and why did you stop?
- Who approves spending to fix it?
- If you did nothing, what would it cost next quarter?

Part 4: A letter of intent should state: the parties, the problem, the scope, the price or range, the timeline, the conditions, and a signature from someone with authority.

Tool 13: Runway Reallocation Calculator (Chapter 13)

Runway in months equals cash divided by monthly net burn. Net burn equals monthly costs minus monthly cash in.

Cost or income line	Current monthly	Bucket (Survive, Prove, Wait)	New monthly
Total costs			
Cash in (revenue, advisory, pilots)			
Net burn			

Cash on hand: _____ **Runway now:** _____ months
Runway after changes: _____ months **Downside runway (revenue down 30%):** _____ months

What proof can the extra runway buy?

Pause plan:

Item	Detail
Start date	

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Item	Detail
Minimum-cost operating mode	
Assets to protect (code, data, accounts, marks)	
People on call, and terms	
Restart trigger	
Review date	
Owner	

Tool 14: Capital Requirement Model (Chapter 14)

Proof to be bought	Capital required	Duration	Success metric	Funding source	What it unlocks
Total					

The funding request on one page

Field	Answer
Capital required	
Purpose	
What will be proved	
The milestone and deadline	
Next decision if achieved	
Failure response	

Dilution check: ownership kept after rounds equals (1 minus round 1 share) times (1 minus round 2 share) times (1 minus round 3 share). Convertible at a cap: investment divided by post-money cap equals ownership at the cap. Rounds: _____ Result:

Tool 15: Internal Venture Charter (Chapter 15)

Field	Answer
Problem	
Target customer (external, paying)	
Strategic rationale and the hypothesis behind it	
Commercial model	
Parent assets used, and what the venture pays for them	
Budget by tranche	
Sponsor	
Venture owner	
Decision rights	
90-day proof	
Kill criteria	
What the venture must never do to the core business	
Next funding gate and its evidence	
Exit options (scale, spin out, partner, close)	

Stage gates

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Gate	Evidence required	Tranche	If missed
0: Charter			
1: 90-day proof			
2: Repeatability			
3: Scale decision			

Tool 16: Technology-to-Economics Map (Chapter 16)

Payback in months equals implementation cost divided by (monthly benefit minus monthly running cost).

Technology	Operational change	Economic variable	Expected monthly benefit	Measured by	Implementation cost	Monthly running cost	Payback

Five questions for every technology choice: What cost does it reduce? What revenue does it create? What capacity does it unlock? What risk does it remove? What advantage does it create?

Dependency check: What share of our cost or capability depends on it? How long to switch? What would switching cost? What if the price doubles?

Compared with doing nothing, is the case still positive? _____

Tool 17: Build, Buy, Partner Decision Tool (Chapter 17)

Score each option from 1 (unfavourable) to 5 (favourable). Weighted score for an option equals the sum of each criterion's weight times its score. Weights must add to 100%.

Criterion	Weight	Build	Buy	Partner	License
Cost over three years					
Speed to market					
Control					
IP ownership					
Risk					
Strategic importance					
Weighted score	100%				

Three-year total cost: Build _____ Buy _____
Partner _____ License _____

If this capability disappeared tomorrow, would our advantage disappear with it? _____

Exit cost and lock-in for the leading option:

Walk-away trigger written in advance:

Tool 18: Scale, Pivot, or Kill Dashboard (Chapter 18)

Test	Evidence	Score (1 to 5)	The critical question
1. Evidence			Are customers paying, and will they repeat?
2. Economics			Does one unit make money, with a credible path if not?
3. Market			Is it large and reachable enough?
4. Execution			Can we deliver at volume without losing quality, cash, or margin?
5. Capital			Can we fund the next proof?
6. Competitive advantage			Is there something worth defending?
7. Strategic fit			Is it the right business for us, now?

Pattern, not just the total: which tests are weak, and is each weakness temporary or structural?

Decision (circle one): SCALE PIVOT PAUSE SELL
KILL

The reason, in one sentence: _____

The sunk-cost question: if this were not my business today, knowing what I know now, would I invest in it?

Decision log

Date	Decision	Reason	Action	Owner	Review date

About the Author

Emmanuel C. Ikehi is a Nigerian author, entrepreneur, and digital innovator with nearly two decades of experience in business development, commercial structuring, fundraising, and hands-on product delivery across fintech, Web3, marketplace commerce, gaming, and hospitality. He is the Founder and CEO of Swapplee Technologies Ltd and the author of *The Blank Sheet Operator*, *Wealth Creation in the Digital Age*, and *Forgotten Giants*.

Website: www.emmanuelikehi.com